

ENGAGE AI

The Expert Take

What is the **next BIG thing** for **hospitality**



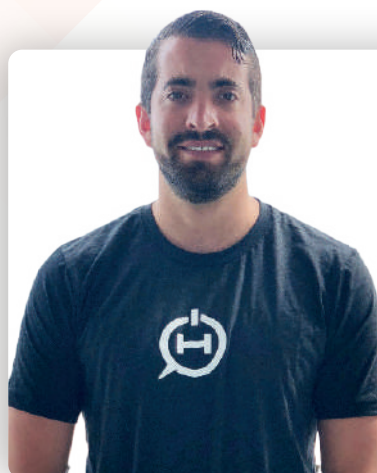


**Pre-COVID the focus was on
optimizing revenue.**

But since March 2020, it has moved to revenue generation by ARPC (Average revenue per customer) through increasing ancillary revenue per guest. Ensuring maximum revenue with maximum guest satisfaction is the need of the hour.

Yogeesh Chandra

Head - New Product Strategy and M&A
RateGain



**Guest experience suite is
coalescing which is**

going to enable a new product category of general guest experience and for the first time, there is going to be a guest messaging company that will eventually break through and get to the next level of scale.

Jordan Hollander

Co-founder,
HotelTechReport

The world is watching with bated breath to see how hotels are going to cope and grow in the post-COVID era with labor shortages, a high volume of guests and many operational difficulties that are currently plaguing the industry.

With the integration of SAAS and AI into the world of hotels, a new era of digital hospitality is coming to light. What started with a black swan event has now catapulted technology to the center stage of hospitality enabling solutions that were unfathomable a few years ago.

So what does this mean for the hotel industry? Here's what these two experts think

Some big things that the hotel industry is seeing are contactless check-in, upsell software, and guest messaging software, which are currently becoming a huge part of the guest experience bundle says Hollander.

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Because of SAAS, ease of PMS integration and the product led marketing that hotels are looking for, a range of contactless check-ins, upsell software and guest messaging software are gaining traction.

Jordan Hollander

Co-founder,
HotelTechReport

Here's a deeper look.



1. **Contactless check-in**

What first started as a trend during COVID has now stuck and become a long term shift in how hoteliers are thinking about guest experience. It's no longer just a buzzword but something that is actively being done, even in the wake of COVID, in order to boost staff efficiency, reduce lines at the front desk, and capture better quality data.



The major components of contactless check-in are fraud prevention and digital authorisation. So you're capturing user data. This hasn't happened before on property from a technology system. Now there's a piece of technology on users' phones that gives really high quality data to the hotel.

Jordan Hollander

Co-founder,
HotelTechReport





2. Upsell software

Upselling software is driving incremental revenue for every guest and has become the lowest cost revenue stream hotels have because you don't have to pay for customer acquisition, it is essentially already funded.



3. Guest messaging

Guest messaging software is important to improve the experience on property and reduce the friction for anything that is needed on the ground.

These 3 engagement aspects are growing to be very valuable because of the different ways in which they support guest interactions.

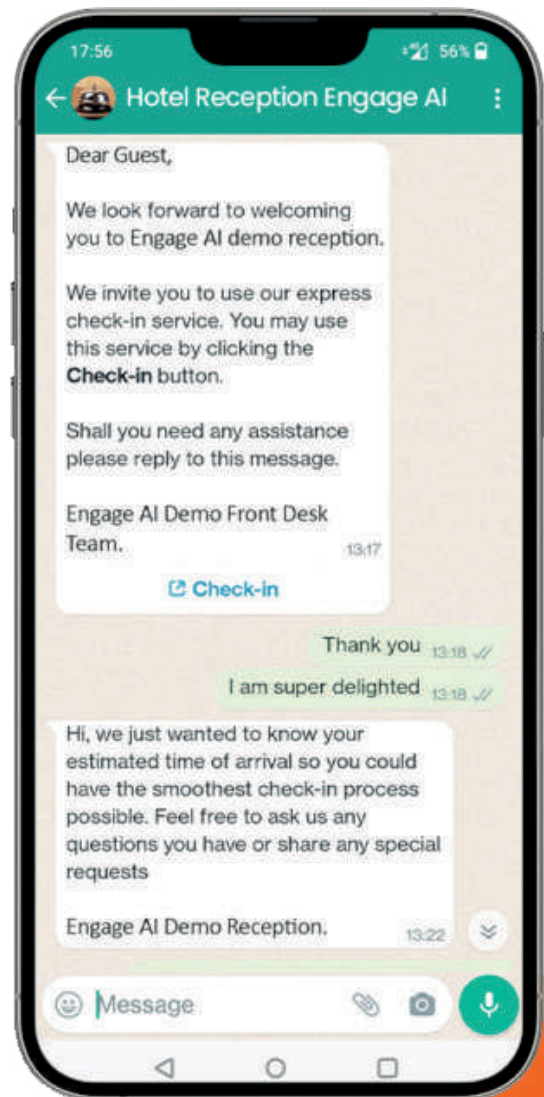


This is because it is solving a few problems. It is solving the problem of expanding revenue per guest, meeting guest expectations and perhaps even exceeding them. Personalization too, which is a challenge that hasn't been tamed properly, this technology is moving in the direction of individual personalization.

Yogeesh Chandra

Chief of staff & Global Head M&A
RateGain

Ushering in a new era of digital hospitality, the world has dramatically changed to make space for tools like the 3 mentioned above. They are soon to become the norm, rather than a trend. What are your thoughts on the changing hotel experience?





**Solution that improves guest engagement
and increases satisfaction**

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